

and operate a car. At an average eight thousand miles per car per year, that totals \$2,640. At 1.8 cars per household, that's a total car expense of \$4,752. Add the cost of household pickups, motor homes, motorcycles, and other toys, and over a lifetime what you spend on vehicles alone could pay for your retirement.

Don't be fooled by lower gas prices in the late 1980s. Hertz says those savings are outweighed by higher depreciation, license costs, fees, insurance, repairs, and maintenance.

Divide your life into two parts. One part is cars: buying, selling, insuring, crashing, repairing, maintaining, lubricating, driving, washing, parking, and putting gas in them. The other part is everything else. Which do you prefer? If you're like me, you're fed up with devoting half your life to your vehicles.

When you retire at age 35 you need neither the expense nor the headache cars can bring. Ride with others or use bicycles, taxis, buses, or airplanes. At first it will seem an inconvenience. You'll have to learn to call cabs, arrange to meet others, and read bus schedules. You'll have to allow extra time to walk. But you can adjust if you work on it. The rule is:

Sell your vehicles

In some parts of the country living without a car may be next to impossible. Most of the cheap places listed in chapter 4 are small towns without much public transport. You may have to use bicycles to get around town and have a local cabbie take you shopping. If you absolutely must have a car, buy an \$800 "station car." A station car is the clunker someone who lives in Cold Spring Harbor, Long Island, might leave at the train station—exposed to vandals, thieves, and the elements—while he commutes to New York City. Insure your station car for the minimum required by law. Use it for trips around town that are too far for a bike. For longer trips, ride with others, take Amtrak or Greyhound, or fly.